Inter—and with Simeone's shirt on the back seat of the car—I headed down the M6 at lunchtime without a care in the world. I'd be with the mum-to-be in a couple of hours.

I remember I was munching on a Lion bar when the phone call came. I nearly choked on the thing.

'David? It's Victoria. The doctor says he wants me to go into hospital and have the baby tonight.'

I've had a lot of things happen during my soccer career that not many other people have had the chance to experience. Every father, though, knows what I felt like the moment Victoria told me what was about to happen. The excitement, fear and happiness—this was the biggest thing that was ever going to take place in my life—left me feeling like I was going to be sick. I threw away the chocolate bar and held onto the steering wheel hard until I stopped shaking. I couldn't get down to London fast enough.

When I got to her parents' house in Goff's Oak, Victoria was in the bath. The pains had turned into something else. She knew what it meant. She looked up at me:

'David, I'm really nervous.'

You're not the only one. I didn't know what to say. We got everything ready and headed for the hospital, the Portland, in London. Victoria was going to have an elective caesarean: the doctor had decided it was the safest thing for her and for the baby. Everything happened so quickly. We barely had time to put Victoria's bag down before we were taken up to this small room beside the operating theatre where she got fitted up with a drip and had her epidural. I think those were the tensest few minutes of all. There was a little panic about getting me gowned up: I ended up wearing a pair of those blue hospital pants that were at least five sizes too big. Maybe it was better to be worrying and giggling about that than thinking too hard about what was waiting on the other side of those double doors.

Victoria was rolled through on a trolley and then transferred to the bed in the operating room. I followed her through. I squeezed her hand and told her I loved her.

'What's going on?' she asked me. 'I can't feel anything, you know.'

Which was good because, by then, they'd already made the incision. I'd